

and encouraging participation of developers from various backgrounds.

From an education perspective, SONiC's integration with the Linux Foundation has led to the launch of several free and advanced training programmes, including certification courses. These initiatives empower young developers to learn about SONiC and contribute to its community-driven development.

Q. Are there any initiatives you are actively engaged in for community collaboration and growth?

A. SONiC is showcased at various conferences globally. The largest is the Open Compute Conference held in San Jose, USA. Additionally, there are numerous regional events in countries like India, Japan, China, and across Europe.

For example, we have hosted SONiC's biggest conference at the

Microsoft campus for the past two years in India. Both events drew attendees and presenters from all over the world, and were sold out very quickly with growing participation. These events serve as platforms for sharing insights, presenting advancements, and engaging with the community to foster collaboration.

Q. How does SONiC manage compliance and licensing regulations for open source projects?

A. Each hardware vendor maintains their own licensing, while SONiC is governed by the SONiC Outreach Community and SONiC Foundation. The SONiC Governing Board, under the Linux Foundation, oversees feature development, licensing, and software releases.

Releases are carefully managed to avoid overwhelming users with frequent upgrades and balancing a variety of features for different

market needs. Each update is signed off by the governing board to ensure quality and compliance.

Q. How do you see the demand for open source networking solutions evolving in this industry?

A. The demand is tremendous and growing rapidly. SONiC has become the *de facto* open source networking solution and has the most vibrant community with contributions from a wide range of partners, including Microsoft, Google, Alibaba, NVIDIA, Dell, Broadcom, Cisco and many others.

Service providers, telcos and enterprises are increasingly adopting SONiC and offering it as a service in the industry. Over the next two to three years, the demand is expected to rise significantly as more organisations recognise the benefits of open source networking solutions. 

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